جامعة خليفة
Khalifa University

Minutes of Meeting ARIC SMB Meeting

Date	January 28.2022
Time	11:00 to 12:00
Venue	Web Meeting (Microsoft Office Team)
Note Taker	Zineb Kherrati

Committee Members	Title	Attendance
Dr. Steve Griffiths	SVP Research & Development	Yes
Dr. Abdelqader Abusafieh	SVP Technology & Advanced Materials (STRATA)	Yes
Mr. Hashem Al Kaabi	Associate UAE Clusters (Mubadala)	Yes
Dr. Lakmal Seneviratne	Director, Khalifa University Center for Autonomous Robotic Systems (KUCARS)	Yes
Dr.Wesley Cantwell	Professor and Director of Aerospace Research & Innovation Center	Yes
		Yes
Attendees / Invited Members		
Dr. Yahia Zweiri	Associate Professor	

Agenda items Minutes of Meeting

- Minutes of the last SMB – Review
- Publicizing ARIC's activities

  ✓ Mr. Sayed to send the Draft of ARIC Media/Communication strategy to the SMB for review and endorsement (Dr. Wesley to follow up)

- ARIC Branding/ Renaming

  ✓ Mr. Sayed to suggest an approach to rebranding (Dr. Wesley to follow up)

- Presentation and approval of the budget for 2022 and the final budget status for 2021:

  ✓ Dr. Wesley shared the proposed budget. Drs. Abdelqader and Wesley worked initially on establishing a budget of 2.3 million, assuming a carryover of 500k, but Finance subsequently indicated that the carryover will be only 200k and then subsequently revised it further downwards to 150k. The revised budget is 1.951.432 AED. The total personnel budget now amounts to 1.3 m AED, and

the Opex budget which has funding for the 4 projects, 3D printing, Thermoplastics, Robotics and Exoskeleton, comes to 643,000 AED.

- ✓ Dr. Abdelqader highlighted the somewhat limited budget and stressed the need to generate additional funding in addition to the existing fund.

Recommendations:

- ✓ The budget is accepted and approved by the SMB. It was noted that ARIC needs additional funding to further develop its activities.
- ✓ Dr. Abdelqader suggested to check the possibility of undertaking the 2 additional Sanad projects proposed by Dr. Yahta using the current resources that have been allocated, if not then, he suggested checking with engineers from Sanad to see if they could assist in some way with both projects.
- ✓ Dr. Steve suggested to define which projects to put the students on, and to prepare a plan, By prioritizing having Nationals involved, it will add value, connecting students to Mubadala and Sanad is a priority for KU
- ✓ Dr. Steve and Dr. Abdelqader to explore additional opportunities with help of Dr. Arif and Mubadala.

- **Update on staff in ARIC**

  - ✓ Dr. Abdulqader recommended to increase Abdulla's salary, in order to recognize his excellent performance and to retain him.
  - ✓ Dr. Wesley will follow-up on process with Blake and present to Dr. Steve to take forward

- **Final performance on KPIs for 2021**

  1. Number of Q1 papers published through ARIC team: 6 papers published, 2 papers accepted and 3 submitted
  2. Number of problems being solved for industry : Thermoplastic aircraft rib, Repair of turbine blades, Drilling of aerospace structures
  3. Number if UAE nationals deployed on ARIC Projects: 17 students
  4. Number of patents filed : a novel multi-purpose based system for high – precision in Industrial robotic machining, under-actuated cable robot with passive stabilization
  5. Number of Articles in local international media highlighting ARIC: 3 have been prepared

Comments:

- Dr. Abdelqader suggested searching for applications for 3D printing and developing appropriate projects linked to problem solving.

- **Brief updates on the projects in ARIC**

  - ✓ Dr. Wesley updated the SMB on ARIC projects and their success
  - ✓ Dr. Wesley informed the SMB members that Mariam Al Dhaheri has successfully defended her PhD, proposal in late Nov 2021.
  - ✓ Dr. Abdulqader stressed the need to plan the next phase of the thermoplastic project, and suggested a discussion with Gordan to brainstorm and identify the next steps in the project
  - ✓ 3 D printed rocket engine: Dr. Abdelqader requested Dr. Wesley to follow up with Dr. Rashid to identify more relevant projects for collaboration.

- **ARIC change of name:**

  - ✓ Dr. Abdelqader proposed to change the ARIC name to a broader name including advanced materials, 2 names were proposed to the SMB:
    1. Advanced research and innovation center OR
    2. Applied research and innovation center

<u>Recommendations:</u>

- ➢ SMB members agreed to change the ARIC name to the **<u>Advanced research and innovation center</u>**

- **Prof. Cesare's departure - leadership in ARIC Digital**

  - ✓ Dr. Yahia is now taking over the leadership of the ARIC digital activities , Dr. Wesley to look after the manufacturing projects and Dr. Yahya will direct the digital projects.

- **Charging external entities for use of ARIC equipment**

  - ✓ Dr. Wesley to send an email to Dr. Abdelqader to check the possibility of the ARIC Digital staff using the Strata office in L Building.

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Outcome & Action Items (to be completed prior to next SBM)

- **Publicizing ARIC's activities**

  - Mr. Sayed to send the Draft of ARIC Media/Communication strategy to the SMB for review and endorsement (Dr. Wesley to follow up)

- **ARIC Branding/ Renaming**
    - Mr. Sayed to suggest an approach to rebranding (Dr. Wesley to follow up**)**
- **Patent filing**
    - SMB members to review Tremonti assessments prepared for ARIC and discuss next steps to advance the projects in the next SMB
- **Update on staff in ARIC**
    - Dr. Wesley to check with Blake on the requested salary increase for Abdulla Ayyad and understand the process to accomplish it
- **Charging external entities for use of ARIC equipment**
    - Dr. Wesley to Discuss it with Jeremie and Peter, and to have the equipment's specification, to send the proposal to the SMB members for approval
    - Dr. Wesley to send an email to Dr. Abdelqader to check the possibility of ARIC research staff using the Strata office in L Building.
- **ARIC change of name:**
    - Dr. Wesley to send an email to Sayed informing him of the change of ARIC name to Advanced Research and Innovation Center.
    - Dr. Wesley to check with the legal team on the name change of ARIC
- **Research staff**
    - Dr. Wesley to email Dr. Yusra to find out her selected ARIC project for the KU UAE National Post-doctoral program application.
- **Thermoplastics project , Dr. Wesley to schedule a meeting and include** (Dr. Abdelqader, Wesley, Gordon
- Dr. Lakmal to develop robotics projects proposals with KU student allocations and include items to make the case for value added (partners in this programs, opportunity, student training technology development, the impact they can have),and share with the SMB for their endorsement
- Dr. Steve to help take this forward within KU system

SMB Minutes of Meeting Approval:

Committee Members	Signature	Date
Dr. Steve Griffiths		14/02/2022
Dr. Abdelqader Abusafieh		Feb 15_2022
Mr. Hashem Al Kaabi	HAK	9 Feb 2022
Dr. Lakmal Seneviratne		Feb 15_2022